

CURIOSITY

Rover

Curiosity landed on Mars on 6 August 2012, with a mission to explore the Red Planet's surface. The largest and most complex rover ever sent to another planet, it has found organic molecules – the building blocks of life – in Martian rocks. It has also sniffed traces of methane gas, which can be produced by living cells.

DATA FILE



SIZE: 2.2 m (7.2 ft) tall



DATE OF LAUNCH: 26 November 2011



MISSION DURATION: Ongoing



SPACE AGENCY: NASA



The Martian surface as seen by Curiosity

Laser vapourizes rocks up to 7 m (23 ft) away, to analyse their composition

Curiosity played "Happy Birthday to You" on the first anniversary of its landing.